beyond age 65, take up woodworking. If you're a plumber and you don't think you can plumb beyond 65, take up schoolteaching. It's amazing to me that plumbers retire and want to teach school, and teachers retire and want to go into plumbing. But it's important that you find a way to keep productive.

(2) *Be prudent.* As Proverbs 27:12 says, "A prudent man sees evil and hides himself, the naive proceed and pay the penalty." Obviously, you are going to get older. The alternative to getting older is not a good one. Plan for it and lay aside some money for the future. If you're living on such a small income that you have no choice and you cannot put any money aside for the future, God can still provide for you.

(3) *Don't rely totally on Social Security.* When Social Security began in 1935, there were 17 contributors for every person drawing from it. Right now there are approximately 7 contributors for every person drawing from it. By the year 2000, we will be down to about 4 people contributing for every person drawing, and by 2015, there will be approximately 2.5 people contributing for every person drawing from the system. That is impossible. Don't do all of your retirement planning around Social Security. It should be a supplement only. There is no way that the system can continue without some changes. A simple solution that will make Social Security solvent again would be to raise the minimum retirement age to about 95!

If you don't want to rely on Social Security, what other retirement plans should you consider? If you qualify for an IRA (Individual Retirement Account), consider saving some money each year to the extent your budget will allow you to contribute. For a discussion of retirement investing, see Part Four, entitled "Ten Keys to Successful Investing."

What about company retirement plans? You need to evaluate your company retirement plan to see if it meets your needs, but let me caution you. Many large companies borrow money from the employees' retirement plan. If the company fails, and many companies do, they can bankrupt the retirement plan at the same time. If I were with a large company, I